

PUBLISHER PITCH · PLAYABLE VERTICAL SLICE · JULY 2026

NOVA GUARDIANS

DEFENDERS OF THE DRIFT

A cosmic roguelite arcade shooter. Fly to dodge, hold still to unleash your guns.
Clear sectors of space monsters, salvage new weapons and powers, and topple
crowned sovereigns of the rift — one run at a time.

4 Guardians

6 Weapons

5 Monsters + 3 Bosses

12 Stackable Powers

Playable Today

One thumb. Total tension.

Nova Guardians is built on the most proven loop in mobile arcade: **you cannot move and shoot at the same time**. Every second is a decision — reposition to survive, or stand your ground to deal damage. It plays in portrait, one-handed, in 3-minute bursts, and it is entirely original IP.

FLY

drag /
WASD to
dodge
monsters &
bullet
patterns

STOP

→ auto-target opens
fire the instant
you hold still

SALVAGE

→ pick 1 of 3 powers after every
cleared sector

DEEP

→ sectors scale
crowned boss

- ▶ **Session shape:** a full run is 5-15 minutes; a death always ends with "one more run".
- ▶ **Build variety:** 4 guardians × 6 weapons × 12 stacking powers = runs that never feel identical.
- ▶ **Instant onboarding:** zero tutorial needed — movement is the only input.



Four guardians. Four ways to play.

GUARDIAN	ROLE	SIGNATURE WEAPON	PLAYSTYLE
 Vex Corran	Ace Pilot	Pulse Blaster	Fastest guns and thrusters — the duelist's pick.
 Kaela Vorn	Warbreaker	Rail Lance	Heavy hull; slow, piercing shots that punch through packs.
 Thornroot	Wildkin	Spore Burst	Homing spores + lifesteal — sustain through attrition.
 Rax-9	Gun Drone	Scatter Coil	Twin spread cannons — brutal up close, risky to play.

ORIGINAL CHARACTER ART

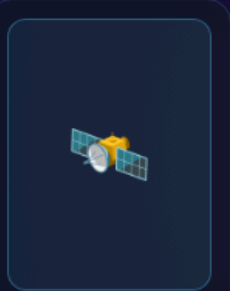
Each guardian has a generated splash portrait (ace pilot, armored warbreaker, living-plant wildkin, battle drone) shown on the roster screen, in a consistent cosmic art direction. All heroes, names and designs are original IP — built for merchandising and seasonal roster expansion.

STAT IDENTITY

HP 90-140 · fire interval 0.50-0.72s · damage 9-14 · speed 190-230. Distinct enough to change how a run feels, close enough that every guardian can win.

CHOOSE YOUR GUARDIAN

Each guardian flies a different ship with its own edge.



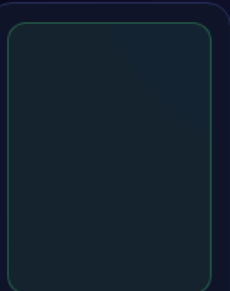
Vex Corran
ACE PILOT

Fast guns, quick fire rate



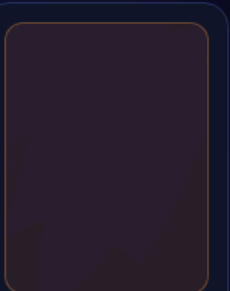
Kaela Vorn
WARBREAKER

Rail Lance — slow, armor-piercing cannon



Thornroot
WILDKIN

Spore Burst — homing spores + lifesteal



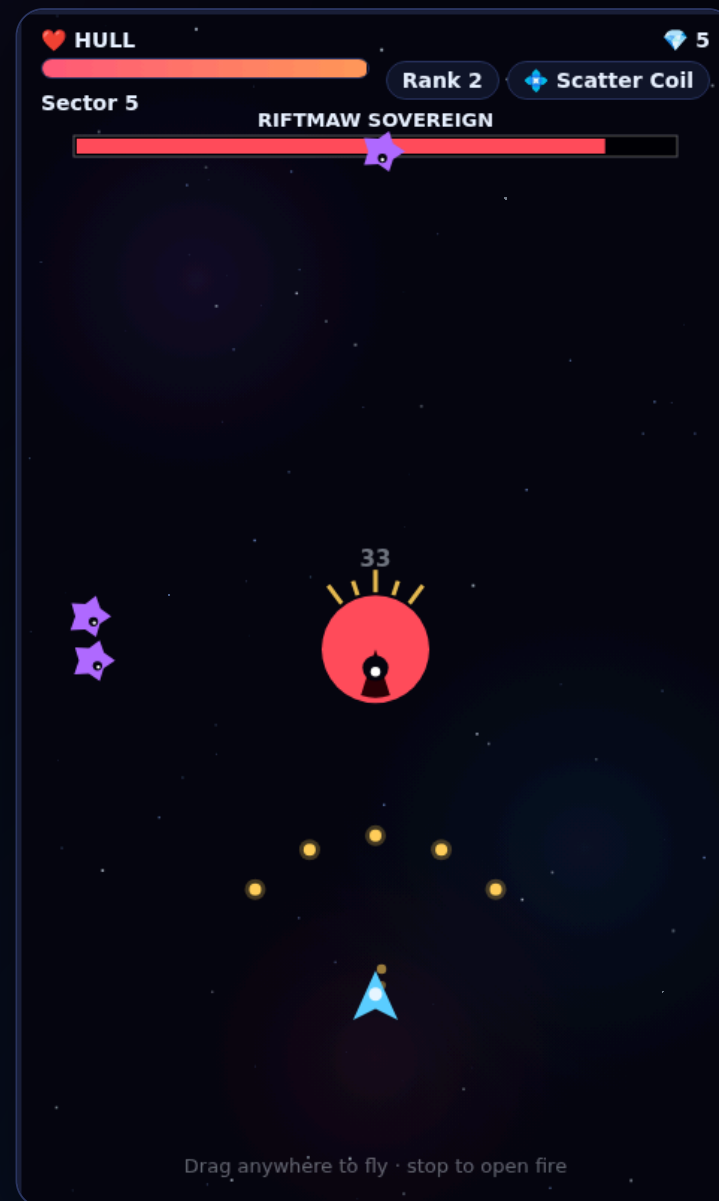
Rax-9
GUN DRONE

Scatter Coil — twin spread cannons

Six weapons that **rewrite the run.**

WEAPON	BEHAVIOR	TRADE-OFF
 Pulse Blaster	Fast, accurate straight bolts	The reliable baseline
 Rail Lance	Pierces up to 4 targets in a line	2.3× damage, 55% slower cycle
 Scatter Coil	5-pellet shotgun spread	Huge burst, shortest range in the arsenal
 Spore Burst	3 homing spores that steer into prey	Never misses, lower per-hit damage
 Nova Orb	Slow seeking orb, pierces	1.5× damage but easy to outrun
 Saw Disc	Twin blades boomerang out and back — hit on both passes	Skill weapon: positioning doubles value

- ▶ Every guardian starts with a **signature weapon**; new ones drop as gold cards between sectors.
- ▶ Weapons are real physics, not stat swaps — homing steers per-frame, discs return on a curve.
- ▶ All 12 powers stack on any weapon: Split Cannon + Rail Lance = a piercing shotgun wall.



A bestiary that teaches by killing you.

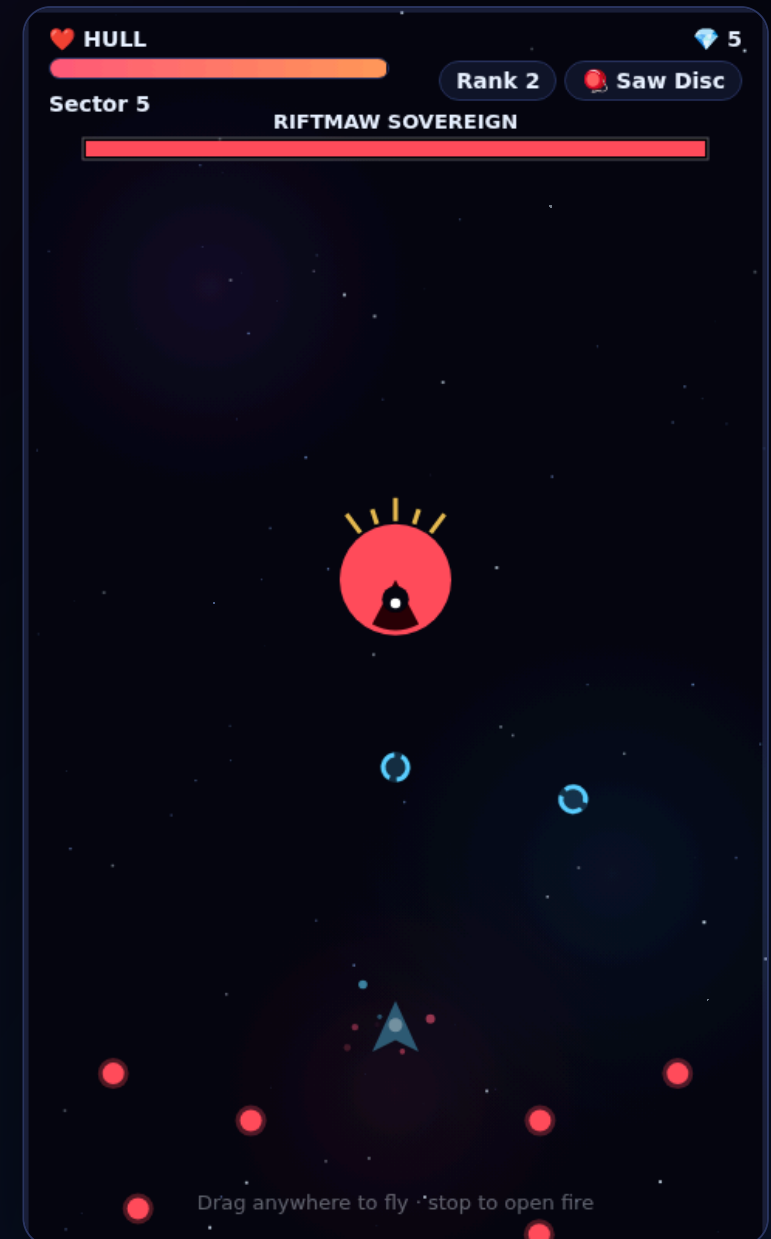
MONSTER	AI	INTRODUCED
Voidling — spiked swarmer	Relentless chase	Sector 1
Glowspit — pulsing gunner	Keeps distance, fires aimed bolts	Sector 2
Ramhorn — horned bruiser	Winds up, then charges	Sector 3
Starwisp — trailing wisp	Orbits you while shooting	Sector 3
Devourer — gaping maw	Slow tank, huge contact damage	Sector 6

👑 BOSS SECTORS — EVERY 5TH

Three rotating crowned sovereigns — **Riftmaw Sovereign**, **Void Tyrant**, **Star Devourer** — each with a named health bar and a four-phase attack cycle:

- ▶ **Radial burst** — a 14-bullet ring to weave through
- ▶ **Aimed fan** — a 5-shot spread tracking your position
- ▶ **Summon** — calls voidling reinforcements
- ▶ **Charge** — a full-speed body slam

Boss kills pay 25 crystals and a **guaranteed weapon offer** — the run's biggest spike of power.



Every sector, a meaningful choice.

Clear a sector, pick **one of three salvaged powers**. Commons keep you alive, rares reshape your fire pattern, epics define the build. Weighted draw (5 : 3 : 1.4) keeps epics feeling like events.

COMMON

Plasma Core ·
Overclock · Shield Cell
· Ion Thrusters

RARE

Split Cannon · Rail
Slug · Bouncer
Rounds · Targeting AI

EPIC

Wing Guns · Tail Gun ·
Siphon Beam · Heavy
Cannon

- ▶ **Ranks:** kills grant XP; each rank adds max hull mid-run.
- ▶ **Crystals:** every kill pays out — the currency hook for the meta-progression shop (roadmap).
- ▶ **Difficulty curve:** spawn budget 3 + 1.7/sector, monster HP +15%/sector — pressure never plateaus.
- ▶ **Catch-up valve:** choosing any power also repairs 15% hull, softening losing streaks.

SALVAGE A POWER

Sector cleared. Choose one upgrade.



Plasma Core

+25% weapon
damage

COMMON



Overclock

+18% fire rate

COMMON



Ion Thrusters

+12% flight speed

COMMON

Tested by machines, tuned for humans.

AUTOMATED SUITE (HEADLESS CHROMIUM, SCRIPTED PLAY)	RESULT
Endurance: all 4 guardians, 75s scripted runs — reached sectors 3-9 with zero errors across 250+ state polls; full flow start → roster → combat → upgrade → death always consistent	PASS
Boss suite: sovereign spawns on cue at sectors 5 & 10, radial fire confirmed (hull damage traced), summons grew the field to 8 hostiles, death pays out and opens the draft	PASS
Weapon sweep: all 6 weapons fire, steer, and clear rooms; per-weapon clear-time telemetry captured	PASS
Stress: sector-12 spawn load + forced-death — hp→0 lands on game-over in the same tick, restarts state-clean, projectiles bounded under sustained flee	PASS

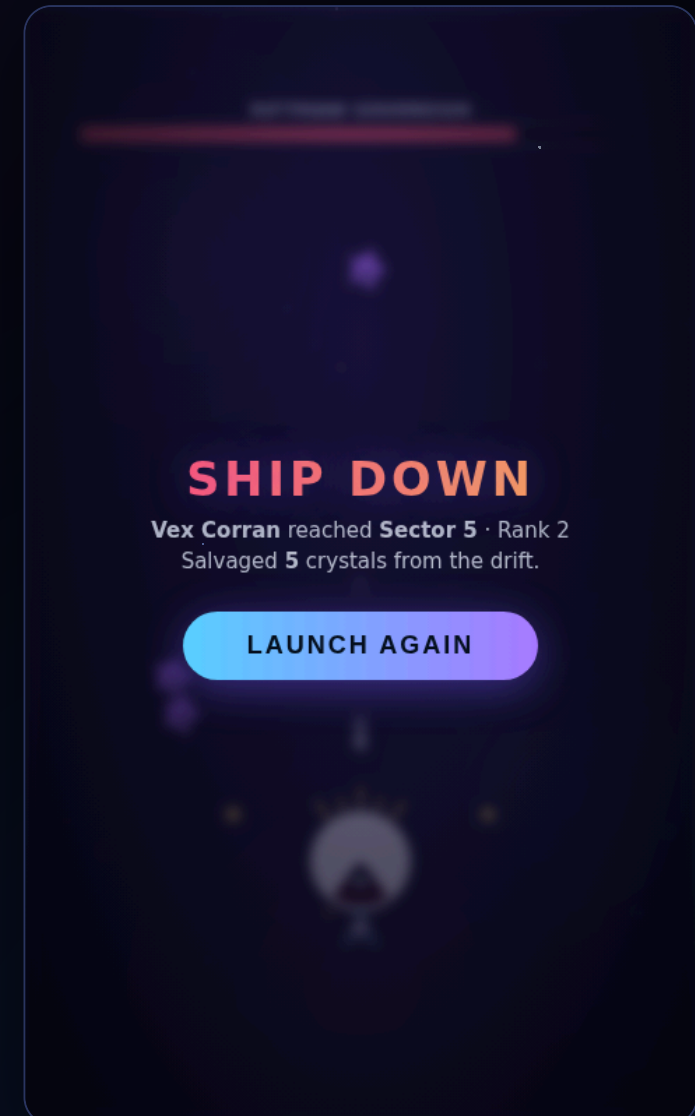
TELEMETRY → TUNING, SAME DAY

Playtest telemetry flagged Scatter Coil and Saw Disc clearing rooms 2-3× slower than the rest of the arsenal — and Rax-9 (who starts with Scatter) as the weakest survivor. Both weapons were retuned and the disc's return pass was made to re-hit targets; a re-sweep confirmed all six weapons now clear within one band while keeping their identities. That's the loop this codebase is built for: measure, tune, re-verify.

INDEPENDENT CODE REVIEW

An automated reviewer surfaced 6 findings (1 critical, 3 major, 2 minor).

All 6 fixed and re-verified in headless Chromium.



Zero dependencies. Ships anywhere.

~45
KB

total playable build
(2 files, no assets
required)

0

external
dependencies,
engines, or build
steps

60
fps

single-canvas
renderer,
delta-time
simulation

- ▶ **Vanilla JS + Canvas 2D** — opens from a single HTML file; trivially wrapped for iOS/Android (WebView/Capacitor) or embedded as an instant/playable ad.
- ▶ **Input-agnostic:** the same code path serves touch-drag and WASD/arrows — phone and desktop from day one.
- ▶ **Procedural everything:** monsters, bosses, starfield and effects are drawn in code — art swaps are drop-in, localization-free.
- ▶ **Deterministic sim:** frame-capped delta time; automation hook (`NOVA_DEBUG`) enables scripted QA and live-ops balance testing.
- ▶ **Tunable economy:** every stat — enemy HP curves, drop weights, weapon multipliers — is a named constant at the top of one file.

NOVA GUARDIANS

DEFENDERS OF THE DRIFT

Space monsters pour out of the rift, sector after sector. Fly to dodge, hold still to unload your guns, and grab a new power after every wave. How far across the galaxy can your guardian hold the line?

CHOOSE GUARDIAN

Fly: **WASD / Arrows** or **drag** · Auto-fire when still

An original game — inspired by the cosmic roguelite-shooter genre.

From vertical slice to live game.

PHASE	SCOPE	WHY IT MATTERS
NOW ✓	Core loop, 4 guardians + portrait art, 6 weapons, 12 powers, 5 monsters, 3 rotating bosses, scaling difficulty, touch + keyboard	Playable proof of the loop
NEXT	Crystal meta-shop (permanent ship upgrades), daily runs with fixed seeds, 3 new biome palettes, sound & haptics, weapon icon art	Retention: a reason to return daily
SOON	Guardian #5-8 (seasonal roster), elite monster modifiers, artifact/relic slot system, cloud saves, leaderboards	Depth for the mid-game player
LIVE	Battle-pass seasons themed on new rift regions, cosmetic trails/skins, limited-time boss rushes	Monetization without pay-to-win

MONETIZATION POSTURE

Cosmetics + battle pass + optional ads (revive / double crystals). The crystal economy is already live in the slice; every hook lands on an existing system rather than a redesign.

THE ASK

The loop is proven. The galaxy is ours.

Nova Guardians pairs the most battle-tested loop in mobile arcade with fully original heroes, monsters and weapons — engineered lean enough to ship as a playable ad, deep enough to run as a live game. The vertical slice is playable today, in one file, on any device with a browser.

✓ Playable vertical slice

✓ 100% original IP

✓ Automated QA in place